

Beauty Pass

It is sometimes also called as diffuse pass or colour pass which is the main pass and has all the lighting information except for reflection, highlights and shadows

Highlight Pass

They are also referred to as specular pass at times. This pass shows the brightest parts of the image.

Reflection Pass

This pass shows the reflections of the surrounding objects.

Shadow Pass

This pass shows the location of the shadow in the scene.

Effects Passes

These passes include all the smoke, fire, wisps, glows, lens flares etc effects.

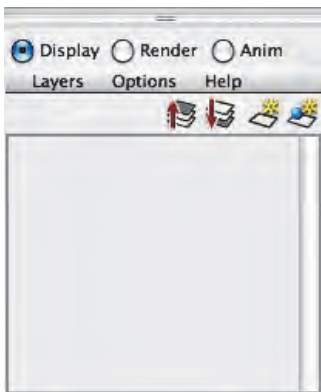
A Depth Pass

Also called as Z-Depth stored the Z information in the file that can be used for putting a depth in a flat image.

Render layers is a very powerful feature in Maya. Let's say you have worked on your work really well with all lighting effects, smoke effects flying everywhere, really nice water simulation and overall the shot is looking fantastic. You used all your energy and stayed up for 2-3 weeks to finish your shot and probably another 4-5 hours to render your scene. When the director comes in and looks at the shot, he compliments you on the great work, but he needs some changes in the smoke, water and some buildings in the centre.

This is going to take a lot of time, energy and effort. Instead, if you have the objects in layers, all you need to do is render them out in separate layers. This way you will have complete control over them and you can do the minor tweaks and render that particular layer which will take probably 1/10th of the time.

This way, when the director asks you to make some changes, you can do that in less than an hour and show him a new version.



You can find the layers under the channel box window

8.1 Using layers and passes

In earlier versions of Maya, the Render layers and Passes were considered the